

# Ilya Gurikov

## Backend Engineer | API & System Integrations | PHP & Python

Open to remote international opportunities

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### PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend Engineer with around 6 years of commercial experience building and supporting production web systems, APIs and enterprise integrations. Strong in PHP, Python, SQL, MySQL/PostgreSQL, REST/SOAP, debugging and business-process automation. I have delivered internal services used across an organisation of 3,000+ employees, built cross-system workflows, and developed an enterprise AI/RAG assistant that reduced a regulatory and document workflow from 2-5 hours to 15-20 minutes per request. Comfortable owning work from requirements and solution design through implementation, release and production support.

### TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Backend & APIs:** PHP, Python, FastAPI, Node.js, REST APIs, SOAP, Webhooks

**Integrations:** Enterprise system integration, CRM integrations, business-process automation, external services

**Data:** MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite, SQL, Redis

**Delivery & Reliability:** Docker, Docker Compose, Git, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Linux, debugging, performance optimisation

**Frontend:** JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Vue, jQuery, HTML, CSS, 1C-Bitrix

**Applied AI:** RAG, vector search, local LLMs, OpenAI-compatible APIs

### EXPERIENCE

#### Full-Stack Web Developer - Gazprom Inform LLC

Aug 2023 - Present

- Built a meeting-room booking service used across an organisation of 3,000+ employees, replacing manual approval workflows and saving an estimated 17.5 employee-hours per week.
- Developed an internal AI/RAG assistant for regulatory knowledge search and drafting internal documents, reducing typical processing time from 2-5 hours to 15-20 minutes per request across a workflow handling roughly 10-40 requests per day.
- Developed internal services for bookings, access requests and cross-system applications, reducing repetitive manual work and the risk of human error.
- Built workflows that generate commercial proposals and submit requests through a corporate SOAP integration bus across multiple enterprise systems.
- Integrated applications with REST and SOAP services, validating and transforming large flat datasets into structured hierarchical domain models.
- Work directly with stakeholders on requirements, effort estimation, task decomposition, solution design, prototyping and production releases; use Python, Pandas and NumPy for operational-data analysis and incident investigation.

Tech: PHP, 1C-Bitrix, JavaScript, jQuery, Vue, Python, MySQL, SQL, REST, SOAP, GitLab CI/CD, Linux, RAG

#### Freelance Software Developer & Independent Projects

Sep 2022 - Jul 2023

- Took on freelance web-development assignments while continuing hands-on software development between full-time roles.
- Studied emerging generative-AI tools and neural-network applications and developed personal projects, building the foundation for later AI/RAG integration work.

#### Full-Stack Web Developer - Onpeak Digital

Mar 2021 - Sep 2022

- Delivered and supported 10+ e-commerce and corporate web projects across the full development cycle.
- Improved legacy website performance using Chrome DevTools, Lighthouse and PageSpeed Insights; implemented lazy loading, image optimisation, caching, Bitrix Composite Site, JavaScript/API optimisation and database-query improvements.
- Introduced Docker and Docker Compose to make development environments and deployments more reproducible.
- Mentored 2 junior developers, performed code reviews, decomposed requirements and distributed tasks in Scrum/Kanban workflows.
- Investigated production bottlenecks and defects across PHP backend, JavaScript frontend and MySQL layers.

Tech: PHP, 1C-Bitrix, JavaScript, jQuery, MySQL, Docker, Docker Compose, HTML, CSS

## QA & Web Developer - IToolLabs

Sep 2018 - Mar 2020 | Part-time

- Developed backend and frontend functionality using PHP, JavaScript, SQL, HTML and CSS.
- Integrated amoCRM, Bitrix24, RetailCRM and custom CRM systems with telephony services through REST APIs and webhooks.
- Worked with SIP/IP telephony workflows and telecom integrations involving MGTS, MegaFon, Beeline and Dom.ru.
- Built a customer feedback widget subsystem with its own data storage as part of the Bachelor's graduation project.
- Worked with Go-based APIs and legacy frontend migration tasks; performed manual QA, debugging, defect investigation and Zabbix-based monitoring.

Tech: PHP, JavaScript, SQL, REST APIs, Webhooks, SIP/IP Telephony, CRM integrations, Go, Zabbix

## SELECTED PROJECTS

### AstroCode - Cross-Platform Subscription Product

Independent Product Engineer | Full-Stack Developer

- Independently designed, developed and launched the product across web, Telegram and Android.
- Implemented user accounts, authentication, subscriptions, YooKassa payments and webhooks, and managed Android publishing.
- Reached 2,158 RuStore page views, 80 installs, 33 registered accounts and 2 paid subscriptions by 16 September 2026 while iterating from real usage.

Stack: React, TypeScript, Node.js, YooKassa, Telegram, Android | [Live product](#)

### Recommendation Engine API - Semantic Search Backend

Backend / AI Integration Project

- Built a semantic recommendation API combining vector search with structured filters for real-estate discovery.
- Used FastAPI, Qdrant and Redis with Prometheus observability and Docker-based local deployment.

Stack: Python, FastAPI, Qdrant, Redis, Prometheus, Docker | [GitHub](#)

### CRM Integration Architecture - Backend Integration Showcase

Backend / System Integration Project

- Designed a reference backend architecture for CRM integrations with typed API contracts, validation and clear service boundaries.
- Documented the architecture and packaged the service with Docker and automated quality checks.

Stack: Python, FastAPI, Pydantic, REST APIs, Docker, CI | [GitHub](#)

### Demiurge Assistant - Local-First AI Knowledge System

Product Designer | Software Architect | Full-Stack & AI Engineer

- Designed and built a local-first knowledge system for persistent fictional worlds and long-running narrative projects.
- Implemented a FastAPI backend, structured entities and directed relationships, RAG and semantic retrieval.
- Built a human-in-the-loop workflow where AI-generated knowledge changes are reviewed before becoming canonical data.
- Integrated local OpenAI-compatible models through LM Studio alongside external LLM providers and developed a React frontend with interactive relationship graphs.

Stack: Python, FastAPI, React, PostgreSQL, pgvector, SQLite, RAG, Local LLMs | [GitHub](#)

Additional public work: [Archive Assistant Bot](#) | [Anomaly Zone](#) | [E-commerce Conversion Analysis](#) | [Data Pipeline CI/CD](#)

## EDUCATION

### Master's Degree in Computer Science and Engineering

Tula State University | 2020 - 2022

Specialisation: Computer Analysis and Data Interpretation | Degree continued alongside commercial work in 2021-2022

### Bachelor's Degree in Information Systems and Technologies

Tula State University | 2016 - 2020

## LANGUAGES

Russian: Native | English: B1 / Intermediate - preparing for IELTS